VFX 709 Final Presentation

Lu Zhang
2026/3/12



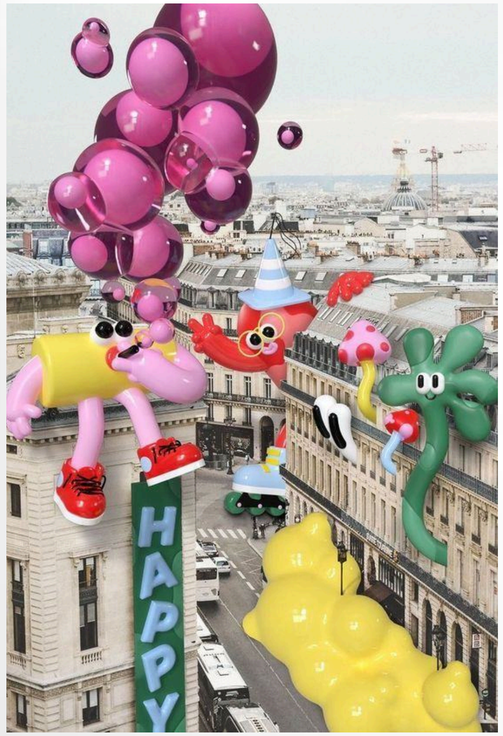


"Attraction" (2017)

Inspiration research



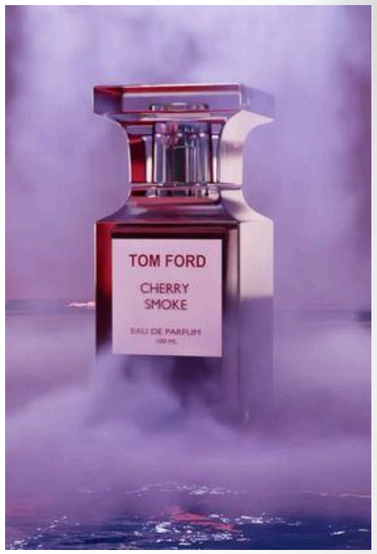
"Dune" (2021)



Pinterest



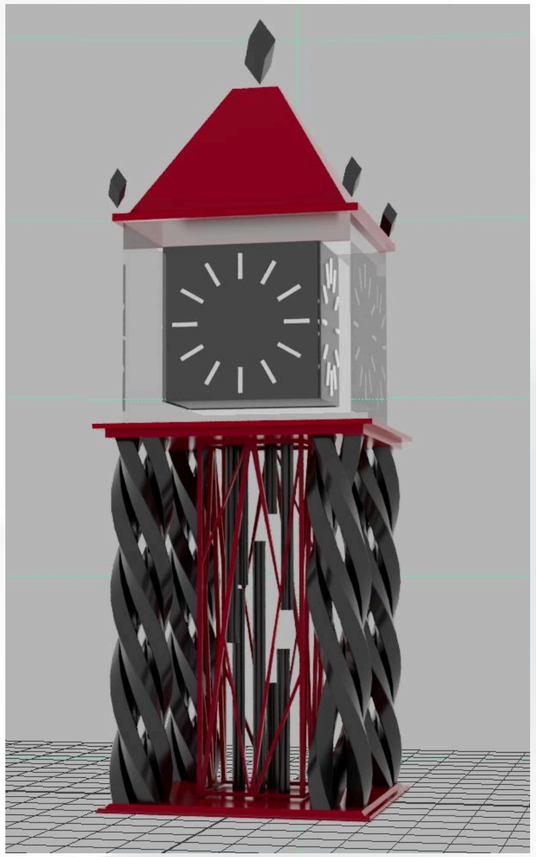
"Arrival" (2016)

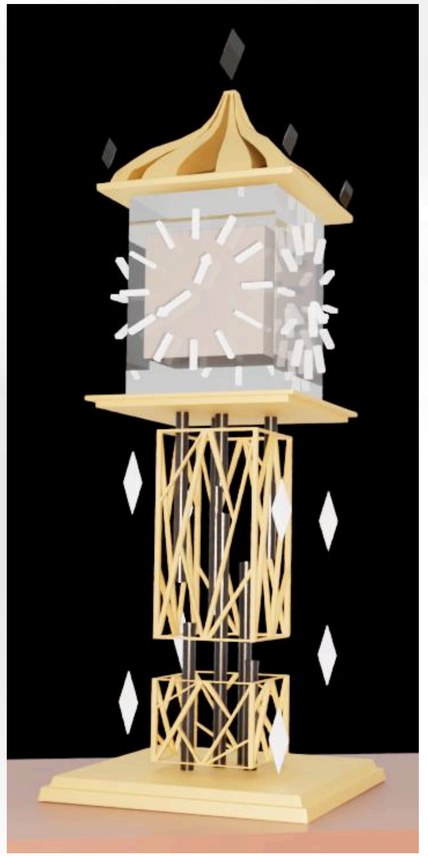


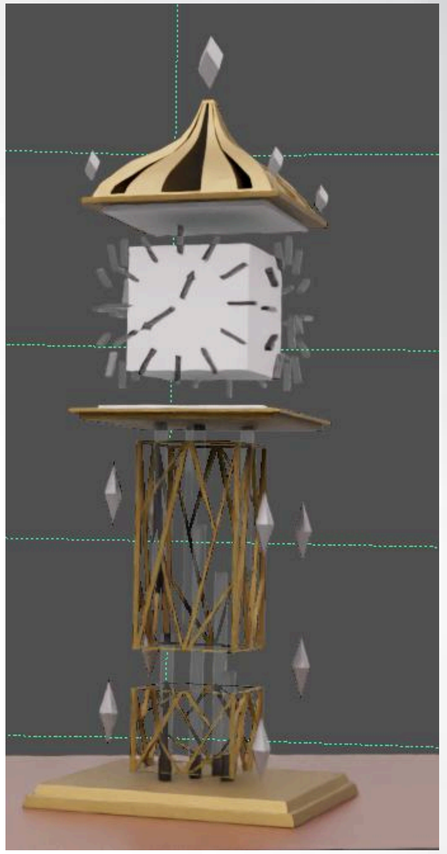
Tom Ford advertisement

3d model inspiration & modeling iteration

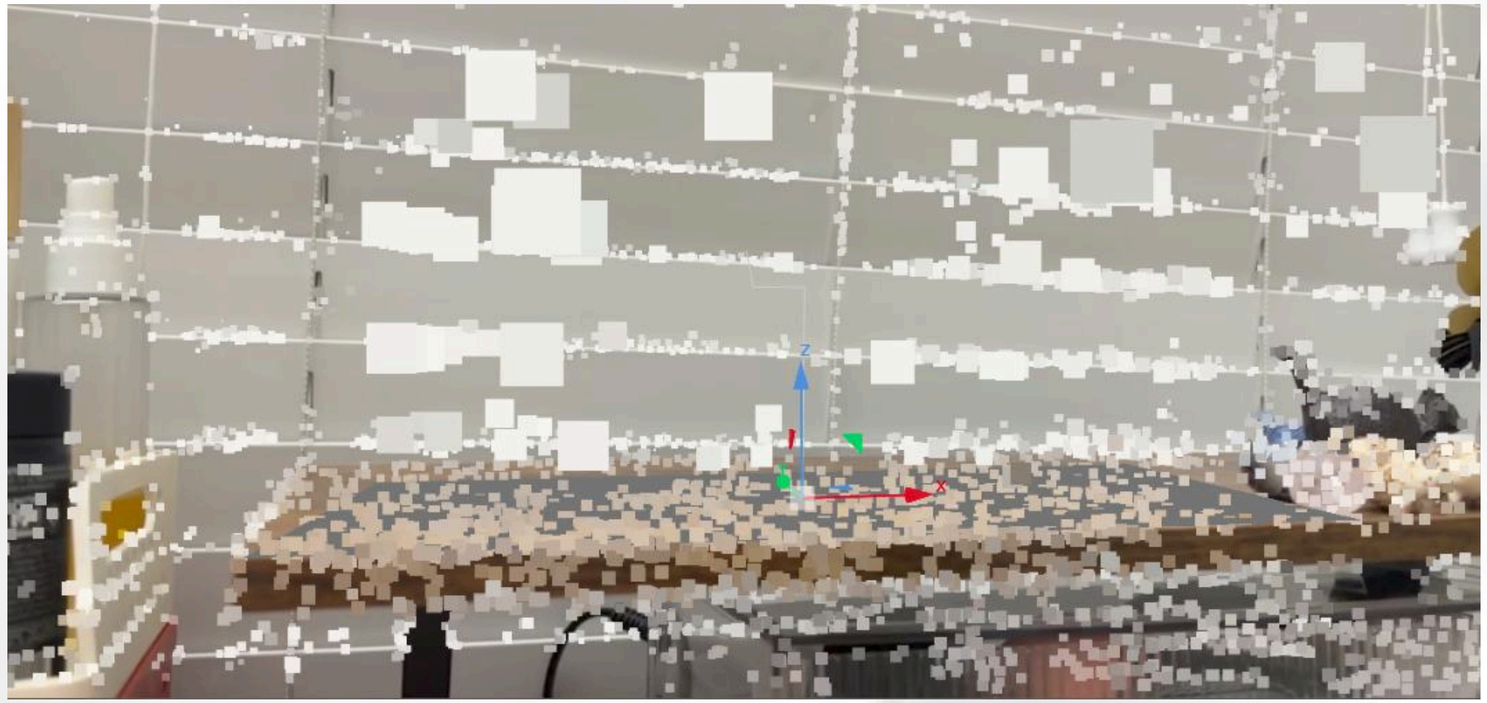


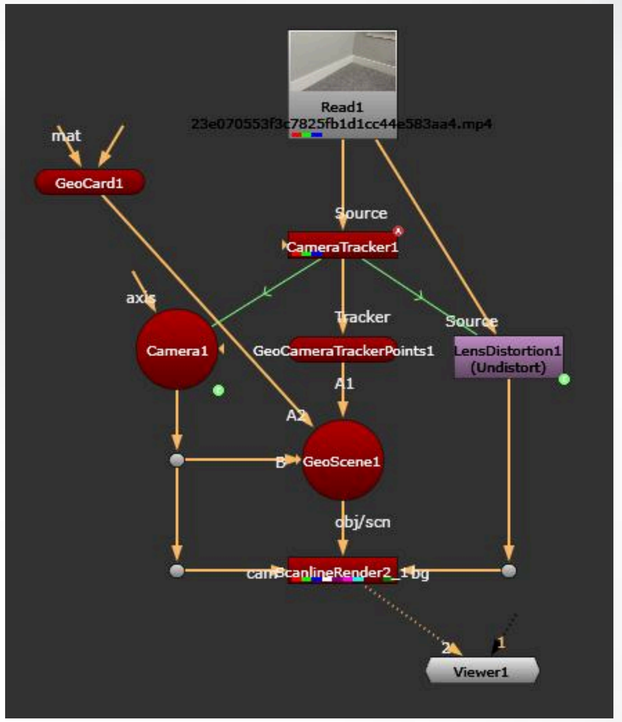




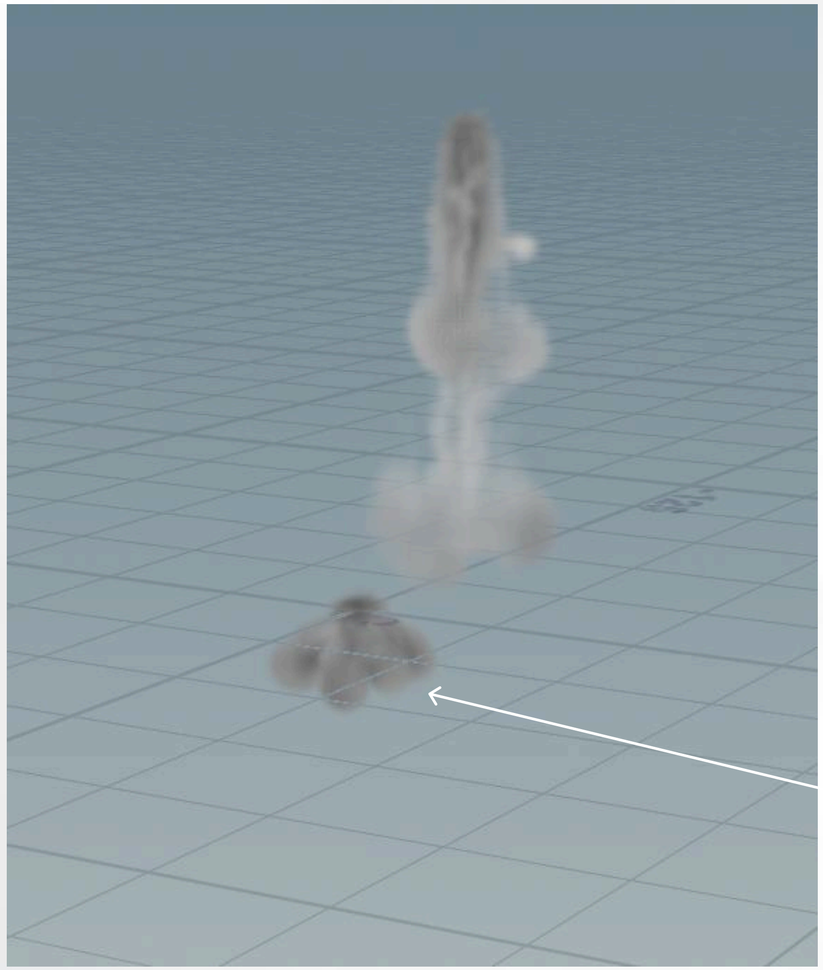


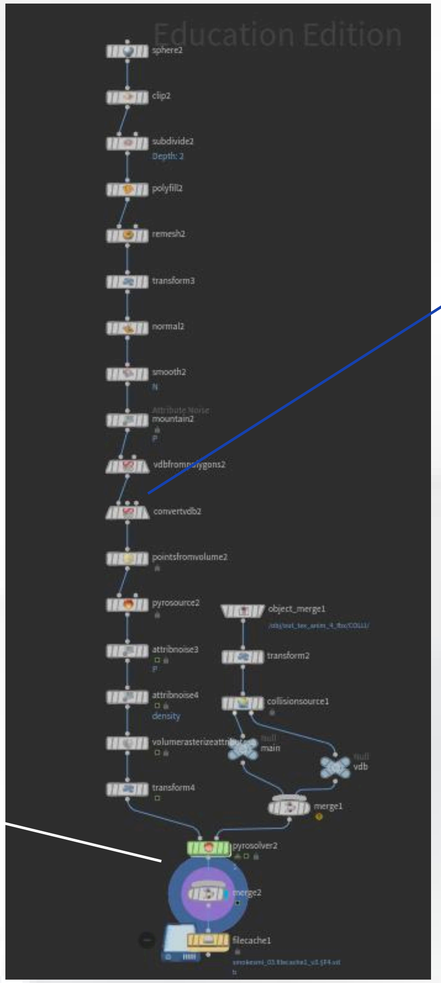
Nuke camera trake

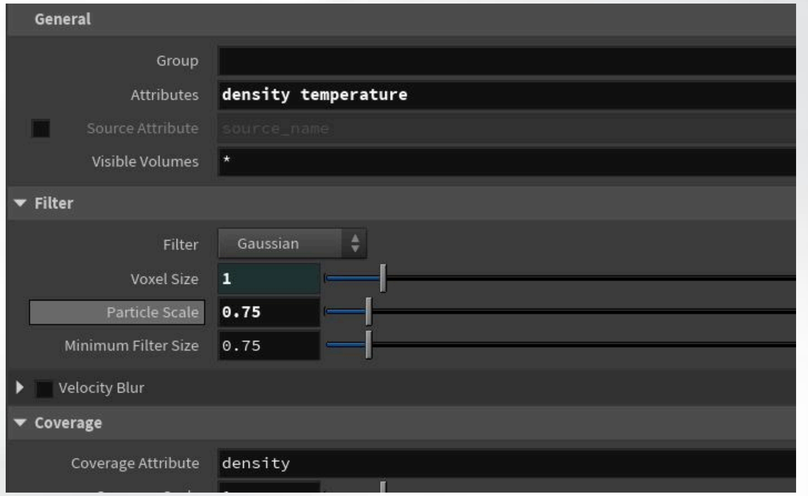




Small smoke plume



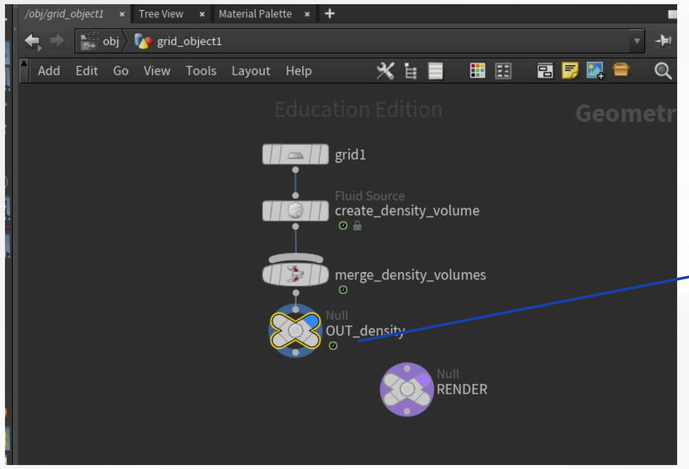


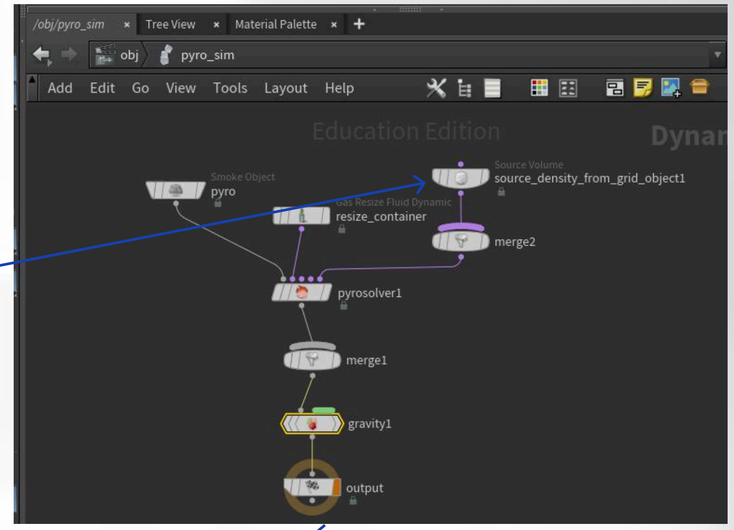


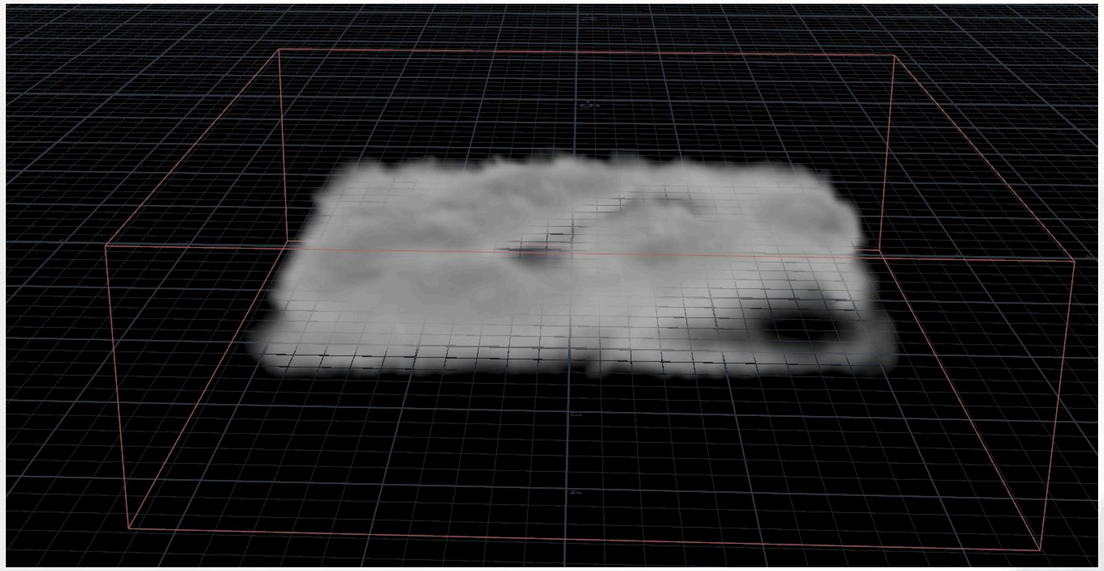
A small smoke plume was created in Houdini using a Pyro simulation.
The simulated volume was exported as a VDB file and imported into Maya for rendering.

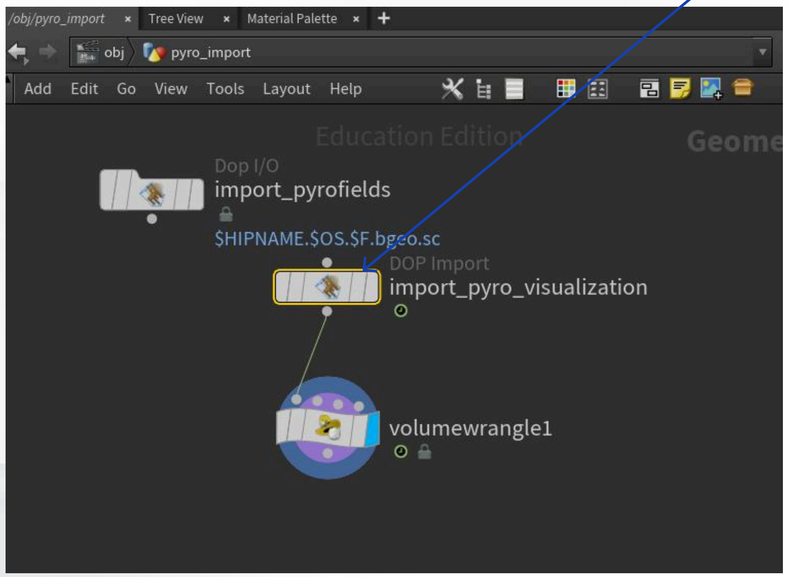
Atmospheric fog

A large atmospheric fog layer was generated in Houdini using density volumes and procedural noise.
This fog adds depth and atmosphere to the scene and was rendered directly in Houdini.



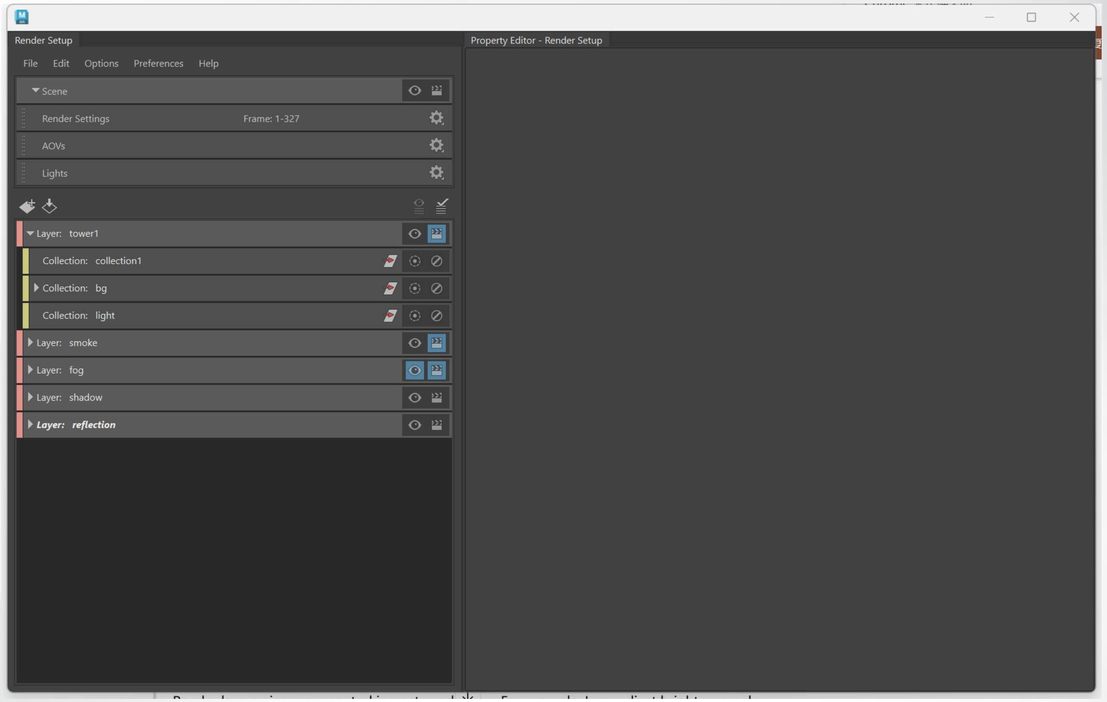






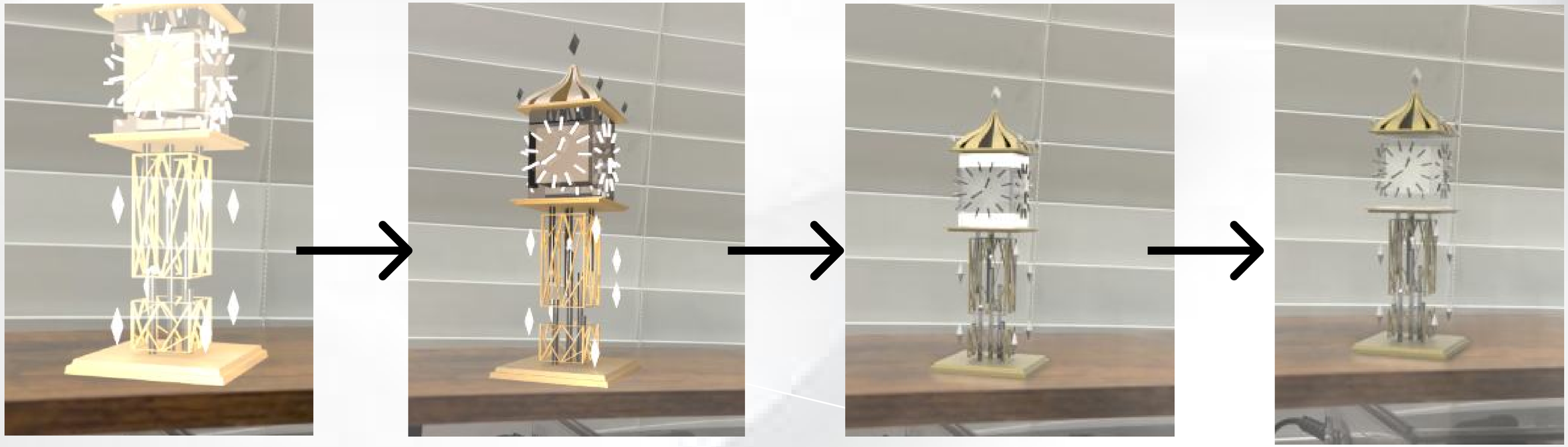
Maya Layered Rendering

The scene was rendered using Arnold Render Setup with multiple render layers.
Separating elements such as the object, smoke, fog, shadows, and reflections allows greater flexibility during compositing.



Nuke compositing

- Incorrect emission shader brings transparency
- Incorrect focal length created perspective mismatch
- Material color did not match the background lighting



Final Output

